with modern technology, and that new technologies can rectify the problems caused by older technologies.[5] The *Pearce Report* also suggests that resource usage can be dealt with through recycling and minimising wastage, and that the use of the environment for disposing of wastes can be minimised in a similar way : 'Recycling, product redesign, conservation and low-waste technology can interrupt the flow of wastes to these resources, and that is perhaps the major feature of a sustainable development path of economic progress.'[6]

Still some questions remain to be addressed. What sort of changes are necessary to precipitate dramatic technological changes? Will technology alone be enough to solve the environmental problems facing us? Should there be no change in our consumption style?

TECHNOLOGY – AS THE CULPRIT OF ENVIRONMENTAL PROBLEMS

We can take some clues from the first lot of insightful writings by the scholars of the past. One among them was the Harvard educated US biologist Barry Commoner. His writings (supported by empirical data) are considered to belong to the first lot of such views which left deep impact on the scholars and the policymakers of the time, across the world. Barry Commoner, [7] in early seventies, argued that the escalating growth of environmental problems in the USA was due to flawed technology, rather than population growth or affluence. He pointed out that pollution was increasing at a much faster rate than population or economic growth. The difference, he argued, could be accounted for by the emergence of new technologies after World War II. He noted that in the twenty-five years following the war, the production of non-reusable soft-drink bottles had increased by 53000 per cent, synthetic fibres by 5980 per cent, and mercury used for chlorine production by 3930 per cent. During that same period, the production of food, textiles, clothes and metals had only increased at similar rates to population growth (42 per cent); and cotton fibre, wool and soap manufacture had decreased.*